COLD WAR END AND NEW WORLD ORDER

REFORM PARADOX → WHY THE COLD WAR → EASTERN EUROPE, 1988-89 → GERMANY'S NEGOTIATED REUNIFICATION → SOVIET DISSOLUTION CHAIN → GULF WAR ORDER TEST

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure; the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

◆ PRIMARY CORE FLOW ◇ SUBORDINATE EXTRA ★ APPROVAL / REVIEW

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • source generation q6 and all prior artifacts unchanged

00

STAGE 00 REFORM PARADOX

REFORM PARADOX · RESCUE A HUMANE SOVIET SOCIALISM · CRITICISM BECOMES LEGITIMATE · COMMAND IS DISRUPTED · EXPECTATIONS OUTRUN RESULTS · MUST REMEMBER · GORBACHEV'S REFORM PHASE, EASTERN EUROPEAN REVOLUTIONS OF 1989, TWO

INTENT → rescue a humane Soviet socialism → GLASNOST → criticism becomes legitimate → PERESTROIKA → command is disrupted → SEQUENCING → expectations outrun results → MUST REMEMBER: Gorbachev's reform phase, Eastern European revolutions of 1989, Two Plus Four settlement and

CORE CLAIM
- INTENT → rescue a humane Soviet socialism
- GLASNOST → criticism becomes legitimate

MECHANISM
- PERESTROIKA → command is disrupted
- SEQUENCING → expectations outrun results

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- MUST REMEMBER: Gorbachev's reform phase, Eastern European revolutions of 1989, Two Plus Four settlement and
- German reunification in 1990, failed August 1991 coup and December Soviet dissolution are distinct stages.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: MUST REMEMBER: Gorbachev's reform phase, Eastern European revolutions of 1989, Two Plus Four settlement and German reunification in 1990, failed August 1991 coup and December Soviet dissolution are distinct stages.

01

STAGE 01 WHY THE COLD WAR ENDED

WHY THE COLD WAR ENDED · STAGNATION, TECHNOLOGY AND ARMS BURDENS · GORBACHEV, YELTSIN AND REAGAN CHOICES · OPPOSITION AND NATIONALITY MOBILISATION · INTERACTION, NOT WESTERN VICTORY ALONE

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
STRUCTURE → stagnation, technology and arms burdens	SOCIETY → opposition and nationality mobilisation	STRUCTURE → stagnation, technology and arms burdens
AGENCY → Gorbachev, Yeltsin and Reagan choices	VERDICT → interaction, not Western victory alone	AGENCY → Gorbachev, Yeltsin and Reagan choices

CORE CLAIM
- STRUCTURE → stagnation, technology and arms burdens
- AGENCY → Gorbachev, Yeltsin and Reagan choices

MECHANISM
- SOCIETY → opposition and nationality mobilisation
- VERDICT → interaction, not Western victory alone

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- STRUCTURE → stagnation, technology and arms burdens
- AGENCY → Gorbachev, Yeltsin and Reagan choices

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: SOCIETY → opposition and nationality mobilisation; VERDICT → interaction, not Western victory alone.

02

STAGE 02 EASTERN EUROPE, 1988-89

EASTERN EUROPE, 1988-89 · SOLIDARITY, NEGOTIATION AND ELECTIONS · REFORM AND BORDER OPENING · PEACEFUL VELVET REVOLUTION · VIOLENT OVERTHROW; NO SINGLE SCRIPT

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
POLAND → Solidarity, negotiation and elections	CZECHOSLOVAKIA → peaceful Velvet Revolution	POLAND → Solidarity, negotiation and elections
HUNGARY → reform and border opening	ROMANIA → violent overthrow; no single script	HUNGARY → reform and border opening

CORE CLAIM
- POLAND → Solidarity, negotiation and elections
- HUNGARY → reform and border opening

MECHANISM
- CZECHOSLOVAKIA → peaceful Velvet Revolution
- ROMANIA → violent overthrow; no single script

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- POLAND → Solidarity, negotiation and elections
- HUNGARY → reform and border opening

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: CZECHOSLOVAKIA → peaceful Velvet Revolution; ROMANIA → violent overthrow; no single script.

03

STAGE 03 GERMANY'S NEGOTIATED REUNIFICATION

GERMANY'S NEGOTIATED REUNIFICATION · 9 NOV 1989 · BERLIN WALL OPENS · POPULAR PRESSURE · DIVISION BECOMES UNTENABLE · 12 SEP 1990 · TWO PLUS FOUR TREATY SIGNED · 3 OCT 1990

9 NOV 1989 → Berlin Wall opens → POPULAR PRESSURE → division becomes untenable → 12 SEP 1990 → Two Plus Four Treaty signed → 3 OCT 1990 → legal reunification

CORE CLAIM
- 9 NOV 1989 → Berlin Wall opens
- POPULAR PRESSURE → division becomes untenable

MECHANISM
- 12 SEP 1990 → Two Plus Four Treaty signed
- 3 OCT 1990 → legal reunification

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- 9 NOV 1989 → Berlin Wall opens
- POPULAR PRESSURE → division becomes untenable

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: 12 SEP 1990 → Two Plus Four Treaty signed.

04

STAGE 04 SOVIET DISSOLUTION CHAIN

SOVIET DISSOLUTION CHAIN · SOVEREIGNTY AND BALTIC EXITS · RIVAL RUSSIAN AUTHORITY · AUG 1991 COUP · FAILS AND BREAKS CPSU POWER · 25 DEC 1991 · GORBACHEV RESIGNS; UNION ENDS

REPUBLICS → sovereignty and Baltic exits → YELTSIN → rival Russian authority → AUG 1991 COUP → fails and breaks CPSU power → 25 DEC 1991 → Gorbachev resigns; union ends

CORE CLAIM
- REPUBLICS → sovereignty and Baltic exits
- YELTSIN → rival Russian authority

MECHANISM
- AUG 1991 COUP → fails and breaks CPSU power
- 25 DEC 1991 → Gorbachev resigns; union ends

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- REPUBLICS → sovereignty and Baltic exits
- YELTSIN → rival Russian authority

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: 25 DEC 1991 → Gorbachev resigns; union ends.

05

STAGE 05 GULF WAR ORDER TEST

GULF WAR ORDER TEST · OCCUPIES KUWAIT · RESOLUTION 678 · AUTHORISES ALL NECESSARY MEANS · US-LED COALITION · REVERSES OCCUPATION · COUNCIL-AUTHORISED ENFORCEMENT, NOT PEACEKEEPING

IRAQ → occupies Kuwait

RESOLUTION 678 → authorises all necessary means → US-LED COALITION → reverses occupation → CATEGORY → Council-authorised enforcement, not peacekeeping

CORE CLAIM
- IRAQ → occupies Kuwait
- RESOLUTION 678 → authorises all necessary means

MECHANISM
- US-LED COALITION → reverses occupation
- CATEGORY → Council-authorised enforcement, not peacekeeping

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- IRAQ → occupies Kuwait
- RESOLUTION 678 → authorises all necessary means

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: US-LED COALITION → reverses occupation; CATEGORY → Council-authorised enforcement, not peacekeeping.

06

STAGE 06 UNIPOLARITY'S THREE TESTS

UNIPOLARITY'S THREE TESTS · UNMATCHED US REACH · CONSENT REMAINS NECESSARY · REGIONAL ACTORS RETAIN AGENCY · POWER PLUS RULES, INSTITUTIONS AND ACCEPTANCE

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
CAPABILITY → unmatched US reach	CONTROL → regional actors retain agency	CAPABILITY → unmatched US reach
LEGITIMACY → consent remains necessary	ORDER → power plus rules, institutions and acceptance	LEGITIMACY → consent remains necessary

CORE CLAIM
- CAPABILITY → unmatched US reach
- LEGITIMACY → consent remains necessary

MECHANISM
- CONTROL → regional actors retain agency
- ORDER → power plus rules, institutions and acceptance

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- CAPABILITY → unmatched US reach
- LEGITIMACY → consent remains necessary

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: ORDER → power plus rules, institutions and acceptance.

07

STAGE 07 YUGOSLAVIA AND NATO

YUGOSLAVIA AND NATO · FEDERAL COLLAPSE · TERRITORIAL NATIONALISM · WAR, CLEANSING AND DELAYED RESPONSE · DAYTON ENDS BOSNIA WAR · KOSOVO INTERVENTION TESTS NATO LEGITIMACY

FEDERAL COLLAPSE → territorial nationalism → 1991-95 → war, cleansing and delayed response → 1995 → Dayton ends Bosnia war → 1999 → Kosovo intervention tests NATO legitimacy

CORE CLAIM
- FEDERAL COLLAPSE → territorial nationalism
- 1991-95 → war, cleansing and delayed response

MECHANISM
- 1995 → Dayton ends Bosnia war
- 1999 → Kosovo intervention tests NATO legitimacy

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- FEDERAL COLLAPSE → territorial nationalism
- 1991-95 → war, cleansing and delayed response

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: 1995 → Dayton ends Bosnia war; 1999 → Kosovo intervention tests NATO legitimacy.

08

STAGE 08 EUROPEAN INTEGRATION SETTLEMENT

EUROPEAN INTEGRATION SETTLEMENT · ECSC AND EEC ROOTS · MAASTRICHT DEEPENS UNION · EASTERN ENLARGEMENT · WIDENING, SOVEREIGNTY AND UNEQUAL ADJUSTMENT

1951-57 → ECSC and EEC roots → 1992-93 → Maastricht deepens union → 2004 → eastern enlargement → TENSION → widening, sovereignty and unequal adjustment

CORE CLAIM
- 1951-57 → ECSC and EEC roots
- 1992-93 → Maastricht deepens union

MECHANISM
- 2004 → eastern enlargement
- TENSION → widening, sovereignty and unequal adjustment

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- 1951-57 → ECSC and EEC roots
- 1992-93 → Maastricht deepens union

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: 2004 → eastern enlargement; TENSION → widening, sovereignty and unequal adjustment.

09

STAGE 09 GLOBALISATION AND POSTCOLONIAL AGENCY

GLOBALISATION AND POSTCOLONIAL AGENCY · TRADE, FINANCE AND PRODUCTION INTEGRATE · GAINS AND POLICY SPACE REMAIN UNEQUAL · GLOBAL SOUTH · BARGAINS THROUGH INSTITUTIONS AND COALITIONS · CONVERGENCE IS A CLAIM, NOT A LAW · CLOSE DISTINCTION · ECONOMIC STAGNATION, NATIONALITY PRESSURES, LEGITIMACY LOSS, ARMS BURDENS, REFORM

NETWORKS → trade, finance and production integrate → ASYMMETRY → gains and policy space remain unequal → GLOBAL SOUTH → bargains through institutions and coalitions → LIMIT → convergence is a claim, not a law → CLOSE DISTINCTION: Economic stagnation, nationality pressures, legitimacy loss, arms burdens, reform sequencing, social mobilisation, non-coercion

CORE CLAIM
- NETWORKS → trade, finance and production integrate
- ASYMMETRY → gains and policy space remain unequal

MECHANISM
- GLOBAL SOUTH → bargains through institutions and coalitions
- LIMIT → convergence is a claim, not a law

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- CLOSE DISTINCTION: Economic stagnation, nationality pressures, legitimacy loss, arms burdens, reform sequencing, social mobilisation, non-coercion and diplomacy interacted
- Western pressure nor one leader alone is sufficient.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Western pressure nor one leader alone is sufficient.

10

STAGE 10 INDIA AFTER THE SYSTEMIC RUPTURE

INDIA AFTER THE SYSTEMIC RUPTURE · STRATEGIC SHOCK · SOVIET SETTING DISAPPEARS · ECONOMIC SHOCK · 1991 BALANCE-OF-PAYMENTS CRISIS · DIVERSIFIED PARTNERSHIPS AND REFORM · ECONOMY AND IR OWN THE DETAILED VERDICT · EVIDENCE LIMIT

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
STRATEGIC SHOCK → Soviet setting disappears	RESPONSE → diversified partnerships and reform	EVIDENCE LIMIT: The Gulf coalition displayed US-led unipolar capability, while Yugoslavia,
ECONOMIC SHOCK → 1991 balance-of-payments crisis	BOUNDARY → Economy and IR own the detailed verdict	NATO controversy, unequal globalisation and continuing Global South and Indian agency deny final-peace or Western-teleology claims.

CORE CLAIM
- STRATEGIC SHOCK → Soviet setting disappears
- ECONOMIC SHOCK → 1991 balance-of-payments crisis

MECHANISM
- RESPONSE → diversified partnerships and reform
- BOUNDARY → Economy and IR own the detailed verdict

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- EVIDENCE LIMIT: The Gulf coalition displayed US-led unipolar capability, while Yugoslavia,
- NATO controversy, unequal globalisation and continuing Global South and Indian agency deny final-peace or Western-teleology claims.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: BOUNDARY → Economy and IR own the detailed verdict.

11

STAGE 11 COLD WAR END ANSWER SPINE

COLD WAR END ANSWER SPINE · STRUCTURE, REFORM, MOBILISATION AND DIPLOMACY · REPUBLICS, YELTSIN, COUP AND EXIT · GULF ALIGNMENT, BALKANS, EU AND GLOBALISATION · UNIPOLAR MOMENT WITHOUT FINAL WESTERN SETTLEMENT

END → structure, reform, mobilisation and diplomacy → DISSOLUTION → republics, Yeltsin, coup and exit → ORDER → Gulf alignment, Balkans, EU and globalisation → VERDICT → unipolar moment without final Western settlement

CORE CLAIM
- END → structure, reform, mobilisation and diplomacy
- DISSOLUTION → republics, Yeltsin, coup and exit

MECHANISM
- ORDER → Gulf alignment, Balkans, EU and globalisation
- VERDICT → unipolar moment without final Western settlement

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- END → structure, reform, mobilisation and diplomacy
- DISSOLUTION → republics, Yeltsin, coup and exit

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: VERDICT → unipolar moment without final Western settlement.

E

EXTRA SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

OPTIONAL ADVANCED ENRICHMENT · LOWE'S POST-1991 RUSSIA SECTIONS ARE ESPECIALLY USEFUL FOR MAINS · OF COMMUNISM DID NOT AUTOMATICALLY CREATE A HEALTHY DEMOCRACY · LOWE DOES NOT TREAT YUGOSLAVIA AS AN INEVITABLE EXPLOSION · MILOSEVIC'S SERBIAN NATIONALISM, TUDJMAN'S CROATIAN NATIONALISM, BOSNIA'S MIXED DEMOGRAPHY · INTERNATIONAL RESPONSE WAS LATE, HESITANT AND INCONSISTENT BEFORE NATO · BOSNIA AND KOSOVO ARE BEST REMEMBERED AS TESTS OF · LOWE NARRATES 9/11, AFGHANISTAN AND IRAQ IN DETAIL.

OPTIONAL SOURCE DEPTH
- CAUTION: Lowe's post-1991 Russia sections are especially useful for Mains because they show that the collapse
- of communism did not automatically create a healthy democracy or a fair market economy .
- Lowe does not treat Yugoslavia as an inevitable explosion of "ancient" hatred.
- Milosevic's Serbian nationalism, Tudjman's Croatian nationalism, Bosnia's mixed demography and the weakness of compromise made violence more likely.

ADVANCED DEBATE
- International response was late, hesitant and inconsistent before NATO acted more decisively.
- Bosnia and Kosovo are best remembered as tests of post-Cold-War Europe and the UN, not just Balkan history.
- Lowe narrates 9/11, Afghanistan and Iraq in detail.
- CAUTION: He also includes a strong critical discussion of American foreign policy and whether state violence can itself be called terrorism.

LEGACY / NUANCE
- CAUTION: For UPSC, treat that section as historiographical debate , not as an unqualified fact to parrot.
- CAUTION: The safer exam line is: the Iraq War damaged the legitimacy of the post-Cold-War order because the justifications became heavily disputed.
- CAUTION: The Arab Spring is Lowe's reminder that authoritarian collapse does not by itself settle the problem of legitimate order.
- 25 June 2025, NATO Hague Summit Declaration: allies committed by 2035 to invest 5% of GDP annually

OPTIONAL STATUS — This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.

END OF MASTER CANVAS • poster embeds this exact master • tiled pages are overlapping crops of the same pixels